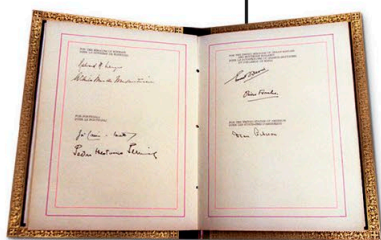




February 1950 The persecution of suspected Communists for “un-American activities” in the US reaches a peak under the influence of Senator Joe McCarthy

1949



△ NATO treaty, original

4 April 1949

NORTH ATLANTIC TREATY SIGNED

Designed to confront the threat of Soviet intervention in western Europe, the document establishing the North Atlantic Treaty Organization was initially signed by the US, Canada, and ten European nations including Britain, France, and the Low Countries. Since that time a further 18 have joined. The only time the treaty has so far been invoked was in response to the terrorist attacks on the US on 11 September 2001.



◁ United Nations Korean War service medal

25 June 1950 START OF THE KOREAN WAR

After World War II, the Korean peninsula was divided between a Communist north and a capitalist south, both claiming to be the true government of a united Korea. In 1950, North Korean forces invaded the south before being driven back by United Nations forces. The UN advance in turn triggered a Chinese counter-attack. The two sides eventually agreed an armistice in 1953.



▷ United Nations propaganda leaflet